

How Legislators Actually Invest Their Time: Constituents ~~or~~ and Policy?

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A constituent-policy trade-off?

- “Potomac fever” (Fenno, 1978)

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- “Potomac fever” (Fenno, 1978)
- “Insiders” who have lost touch
- #DrainTheSwamp

What is Constituent Service?

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Service

- Individual casework
- Organized groups
- Unorganized groups
- Companies

Correspondence Data

MAC THORNBERRY
13TH DISTRICT
TEXAS



Congress of the United States

House of Representatives
June 6, 2008

FEDERAL ENERGY
REGULATORY COMMISSION

OFFICE OF
EXTERNAL AFFAIRS

ARMED SERVICES COMMITTEE
PERMANENT SELECT COMMITTEE
ON INTELLIGENCE

CP08-9-000
PR08-1-000

The Honorable Joseph T. Kelliher
Chairman
Federal Energy Regulatory Commission
888 First Street, N.E.
Washington, DC 20426-0001

ORIGINAL

Dear Chairman Kelliher,

I am enclosing letters from Wayne Hughs, Executive Vice President of the Panhandle Producers and Royalty Owners Association, and Thomas R. Cambridge, President of Cambridge Production, Inc., regarding a pending application before the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission. Both letters are requesting an expedited evidentiary hearing on a proposed lease of firm capacity by Enogex, Inc., to Midcontinent Express Pipeline, LLC, to fully explore the impact on existing shippers. I would appreciate your full consideration of these requests.

Many natural gas producers in my district are concerned about the negative impact the pending lease could have on the Eagle Rock low pressure gathering system in Wheeler County, Texas.

Correspondence Data

Department of Homeland Security Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE)

OCR INQUIRY/CORRESPONDENCE LOG

Date	Member Office	Topic/Issue	Coordinator	Date Closed Out	SP No.
10/29/16	Sen. Steve Daines	Billings Central Catholic High School	(b)(6);(b)(7)(C)		
10/24/16	Rep. Anna Adams	(b)(6);(b)(7)(C)	(b)(6);(b)(7)(C)		
11/24/16	Rep. Lamey	(b)(6);(b)(7)(C)	(b)(6);(b)(7)(C)		
10/24/16	Rep. Brad Warstrup	Ambassador Bible College	(b)(6);(b)(7)(C)		
10/24/16	Sen. Jeannette Ghahewa	(b)(6);(b)(7)(C)	(b)(6);(b)(7)(C)		
10/24/16	Rep. Gordon Maloney	LIU College	(b)(6);(b)(7)(C)		

Correspondence Data

Environmental Protection Agency

CHRISTENSEN, DONNA M-U.S. House of Representatives-D/VI/DC

Total: 28

Control No.	Status	Letter Date	Received	Subject	Last Action
AL-07-000-2996	Closed	Feb 08, 2007	Feb 23, 2007	Governor John DeJongh request a meeting to discuss his concerns regarding the proposed Clean Air Act Section 325 exemptions for the Virgin Islands Water and Power Authority 71 Fed. Reg. 74886-74895 (December 13, 2006)-	ADMIN Kathy Callahan CC aborted due to user office changed.
AL-07-000-8271	For Your Information	May 16, 2007	May 17, 2007	HEARING/SUBCOMMITTEE ON INSULAR AFFAIRS, THURSDAY JUNE 7, 2007 AT 10:00 AM IN ROOM 1324 LONGWORTH HOB/H.R. 1075 (BORDALLO), TO ESTABLISH THE UNITED STATES TERRITORIES INFRASTRUCTURE BOND BANK AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES, (UNITED STATES TERRITORIES INFRASTRUCTURE BOND BANK AUTHORIZATION ACT)	ADMIN Pam Abraham CC aborted due to user office changed.
AL-09-000-6162	Closed	Mar 16, 2009	Apr 27, 2009	SUPPORT THE ST. CROIX ENVIRONMENTAL ASSOCIATION (SEA) APPLICATION FOR AN EPA COMMUNITY ACTION FOR A RENEWED ENVIRONMENT (CARE) GRANT	Kathy Mims Control Closed

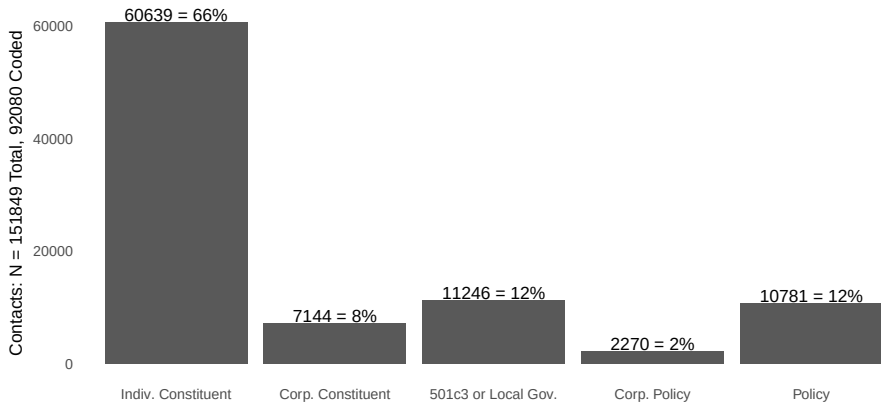
Correspondence Data

250+ FOIA requests to 233 federal agencies (a census)
150,000+ legislator requests (and counting), 2007-2018

	FOIAed Components	Records	Coded	N
Department of Agriculture	29	29	11	1957
Department of Commerce	18	18	10	6875
Department of Defense	49	10	7	5479
Department of Education	1	1	1	3868
Department of Energy	8	2	1	1269
Department of Health and Human Services	15	7	5	6199
Department of Homeland Security	6	5	5	26435
Department of Housing and Urban Development	2	0	0	0
Department of Justice	11	1	1	903
Department of Labor	24	9	6	22936
Department of State	1	0	0	0
Department of the Interior	10	6	5	5171
Department of the Treasury	8	5	4	11143
Department of Transportation	10	6	6	18482
Department of Veterans Affairs	3	0	0	0
Independent Agencies	38	21	18	46182
Total	233	120	80	156899

Distribution

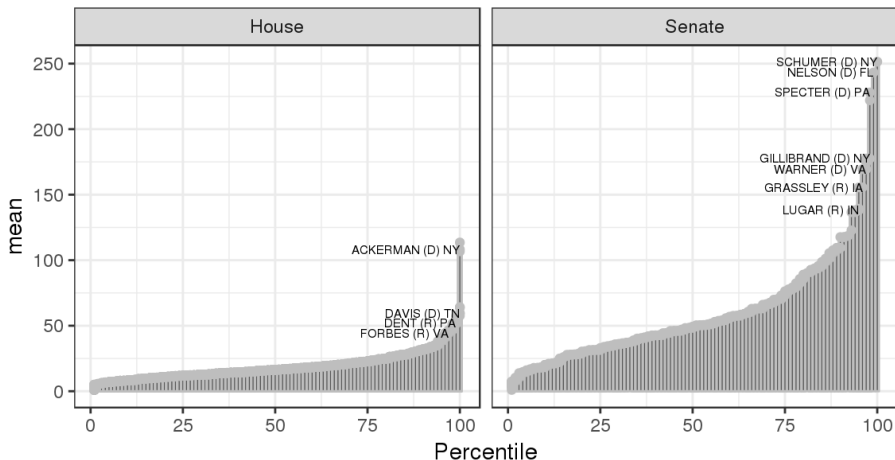
Figure: Distribution Across Types of Congressional Requests 2007-2017



Highly Unequal Rates

Figure: Variation in Who Contacts Agencies

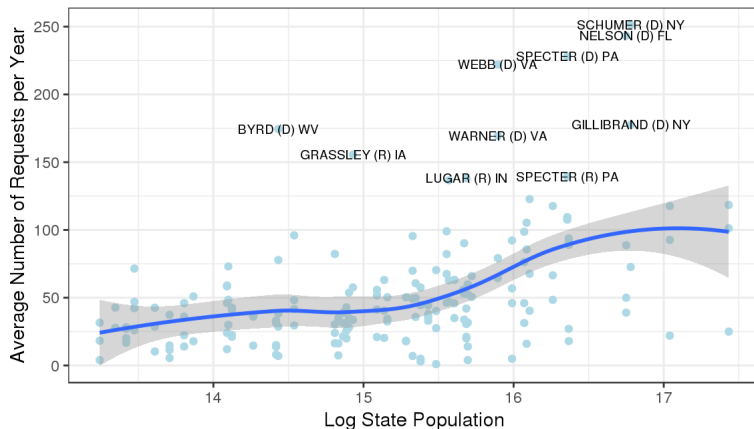
Average Legislator Requests per Year by Percentile



Constituency Demand

Figure: Senators from larger states do more constituency service.

Senator Requests per Year by State Population

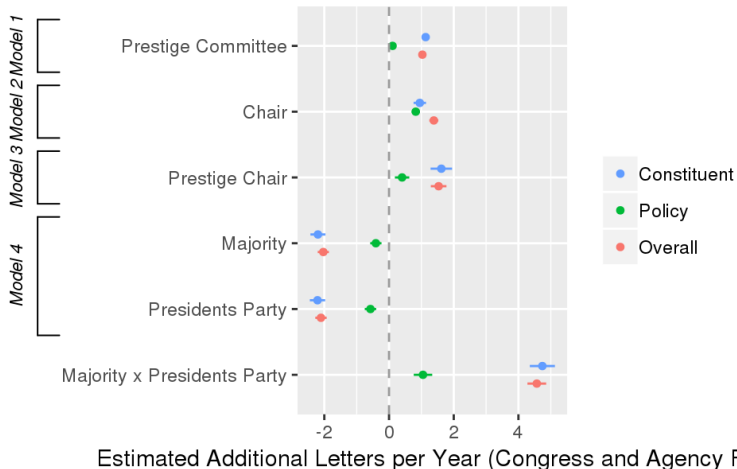


So why do some legislators do more constituency service than others?

Institutional Power and Constituency Service

Legislators who have power advocate more on behalf of constituents.

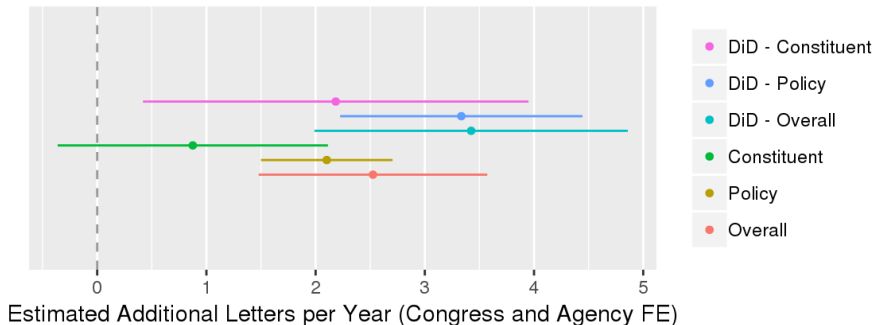
Cross Sectional Differences in Letter Writing



Statutory Oversight Power

Legislators who **gain** power advocate more on behalf of constituents.

Chairs Relative to Other Oversight Committee Members



Questions going forward:

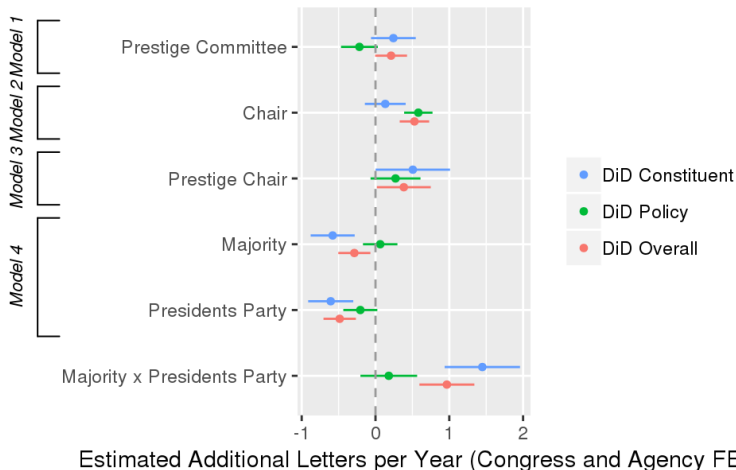
- Do constituents target or demand more from powerful legislators?
- Why is there so much variation, even within strata of institutional power?
- What else?

Thank you!

Difference-in-Differences in Constituency Service

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Difference-in-Differences in Letter Writing



NOMINATE Scores

Figure: Legislators' Ideology Seems Not to Predict How Often They Contact Agencies

